the global trend is not as rapid as it once was. It took just 11 years for the world's population to rise from 7 billion to 8 billion, but the increase to 9 billion is forecast to be 15 years, then another 24 years to reach 10 billion. After peaking, the UN forecasts a world population of 10.2 billion in 2100.

Despite the slowing growth, challenges remain. In 2009, a UN report warned that the world would need to produce 70 percent more food by 2050 to feed its extra population, thereby putting more pressure on land, water, and energy resources. Future population growth is also likely to aggravate many environmental problems, such as pollution, and rising levels of atmospheric greenhouse gases, fueling global climate change.